

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 866

By Vital

A RESOLUTION to recognize Greer Tidwell for his honorable and astute service to the people of Tennessee as Deputy Commissioner of the Department of Environment and Conservation.

WHEREAS, it is the privilege of the members of this General Assembly to specially recognize those estimable public servants who have dedicated themselves to improving the quality of life for their fellow citizens; and

WHEREAS, Greer Tidwell is one such admirable individual, who evinces the greatest integrity and probity in all his chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, after serving with distinction as Deputy Commissioner of the Tennessee Department of Environment and Conservation (TDEC), Mr. Tidwell has taken his well-deserved retirement this year; and

WHEREAS, during his tenure as Deputy Commissioner of TDEC, Mr. Tidwell provided leadership to the Bureau of Conservation and advanced the department's mission on behalf of the people of Tennessee; and

WHEREAS, he also served as a leader across a broad conservation portfolio, including Tennessee State Parks, State Natural Areas, and related divisions responsible for the stewardship of the State's natural, cultural, and recreational resources; and

WHEREAS, under his leadership, Tennessee experienced significant growth in its public lands system, including the addition of fourteen new Tennessee State Parks, expanding opportunities for Tennesseans and visitors to experience the State's natural beauty, outdoor recreation, and heritage; and

WHEREAS, these additions reflected Mr. Tidwell's conviction that access to nature is essential to quality of life and to the long-term conservation of Tennessee's natural resources; and

WHEREAS, Greer Tidwell also supported the protection and advancement of State Natural Areas, reinforcing Tennessee's commitment to conserving ecologically significant landscapes and biodiversity for future generations; and

WHEREAS, one of his most meaningful contributions was his leadership in advancing accessibility across Tennessee's parks and natural areas, supporting the goal of making the State's public lands among the most accessible in the nation; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Tidwell encouraged this work to be pursued with humility, learning, and respect for lived experience, strengthening both the department's culture and its impact while opening the outdoors to individuals who previously faced barriers to access; and

WHEREAS, Greer Tidwell was instrumental in the creation and advancement of the Office of Outdoor Recreation, helping position Tennessee as a leader in connecting people with the outdoors while supporting economic development, particularly in rural communities; and

WHEREAS, throughout his service, Mr. Tidwell demonstrated vision, integrity, and a steadfast commitment to conservation, public service, and the well-being of the State of Tennessee; and

WHEREAS, his leadership and dedication have left a lasting and positive impact on the Tennessee Department of Environment and Conservation and on the citizens who benefit from Tennessee's parks, natural areas, and outdoor resources, and it is most fitting that he be honored on this special occasion; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we hereby commend Greer Tidwell for his honorable and astute service to

the people of Tennessee as Deputy Commissioner of the Department of Environment and Conservation, extending our heartfelt wishes for a happy and fulfilling retirement and every continued success in his future endeavors.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.